

Read the passage.

Blooms in Death Valley

In March 2016, Death Valley National Park in California experienced a rare occurrence: thousands of yellow wildflowers covered the region in a "super bloom." Why was this unusual? Death Valley is the hottest and driest place in North America. The area's average yearly precipitation is just two inches, making it a challenging place for flowers to grow. However, in October 2015, the valley had received more than three inches of rain in some areas. As a result of the unusually wet season, wildflower seeds that had been lying dormant underground suddenly began to grow, producing an abundance of golden blooms.

What is the main, or central, idea of the passage?

Because of an unusual amount of rain, thousands of wildflowers grew in Death Valley in 2016.

Because of the hot, dry conditions in Death Valley, it is difficult for flowers to grow there.

Submit

Work it out

Not feeling ready yet? These can help:



Learn with an example

or



Watch a video

Read the two texts.

Text 1

Lobsters at times have been considered both expensive delicacies and disgusting "poor man's protein." When settlers first arrived in North America, they saw lobsters washed onto shore in piles over two feet high in places. They were so plentiful that they were fed to prisoners and used as fertilizer. Then, in the 1800s, canned lobster became popular, making *fresh* lobster a gourmet food and driving lobster prices up. Today, lobster remains a luxury food item.

Text 2

In Norway, eating *smalahove*, or sheep's head, is a tradition that has changed over time. Centuries ago, salted and boiled sheep's head was a simple home-cooked food eaten so that no part of the animal would go to waste. It was often served the last Sunday before Christmas, with the more desirable parts of the sheep being saved for Christmas dinner. Nowadays, while some Norwegians still serve *smalahove* for special occasions, others just leave it for tourists who are looking for something authentically Norwegian.

Which sentence best combines the main, or central, ideas of both texts?

As cultures change, so can their views on foods, like lobster and *smalahove*.

Smalahove and lobsters are traditional foods that are used primarily in holiday celebrations.

Video

Questions answered

4

Time elapsed

00 16 49
HR MIN SEC

SmartScore
out of 100 ?

9



Questions answered

2

Time elapsed

00 08 41
HR MIN SEC

SmartScore
out of 100 ?

0



Read the quotations below from S. E. Hinton's *The Outsiders*. Match each one with the theme or lesson it suggests.

Knowledge is not the same as common sense.

Hearing other people's points of view often helps us relate to them.

Nature can bring people together.

Questions answered

11

Time elapsed

00 16 36
HR MIN SEC

SmartScore
out of 100 ?

46



Quotation	Theme
Maybe the two different worlds we lived in weren't so different. We saw the same sunset.	
Someone should tell their side of the story, and maybe people would understand then and wouldn't be so quick to judge a boy by the amount of hair oil he wore.	
I'm supposed to be smart; I make good grades and have a high IQ and everything, but I don't use my head.	

Read the following story.

Quest to the Top

Michael loved to play *Legend of Starfell* on his computer. He played online every day and was the expert among his friends. He showed them how to find all the hidden tools and tricks he had mastered.

One day, he was playing online with his friends and telling each of them what to do. In his excitement, he snapped at them when they made any kind of mistake.

"Michael, stop yelling," his friend Mark said over the headset.

"Yeah. I'm playing for fun here," said Jay. Michael apologized.

From then on, however, he started playing more on his own. That way he could be as competitive as he wanted. Sometimes he was already in the middle of a game when his friends wanted to start one. Michael would ignore their requests, so they played without him.

When summer vacation started, Michael filled entire days with *Legend of Starfell*. Meanwhile, his friends made plans to get together. If the plans didn't include gaming, Michael didn't bother to join them.

By summer's end, Michael's progress had stalled. He was highly ranked, but he couldn't break into the "elite pro" level. He was finally tired of playing.

At that point, his friends had stopped calling. When Michael reached out to them, they were busy. Summer was almost over, and Michael had nothing to show for it except sore eyes from staring at his computer screen. He couldn't remember having much fun at all.

Which of the following best describes the main theme or lesson of the story?

People eventually lose interest in the things they enjoy.

Obsession can cause you to neglect what is actually important.

Submit

[Work it out](#)

Questions answered

0

Time elapsed

00 00 56
HR MIN SEC

SmartScore out of 100 ?

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Read the following story.

First Shift

Nolan listened carefully to his manager, who was demonstrating how to ring up orders at the register. The two other new hires were standing a few feet away, playing with their magnetic name tags and coiling the strings from their aprons around their hands. Nolan leaned closer to the screen; he wanted to get every step right.

Mr. Marković noticed that Nolan seemed to be the only one paying attention, so he let him take the first practice order. Nolan's fingers fumbled on the touch screen, and he accidentally hit "burger" instead of "milkshake," but Mr. Marković patiently showed him how to remove his selections and try again.

"If a customer changes their mind, do I hit 'void' here or go back a step?" Nolan asked.

"Back a step," the manager replied, impressed by the question. "That way, the register keeps track of what you corrected."

Nolan's attention to detail impressed Mr. Marković, who decided he could be trusted to work the register for his first shift, while the other two new hires would sweat it out at the grill. Nolan sighed in relief—everyone knew the register was the best assignment.

Over the next week, Nolan continued working at the register but also bagged orders, ran the drive-thru, and even unloaded the food delivery trucks. On Friday night, when he clocked out and slung his apron over his shoulder, Mr. Marković called him into the break room.

"Nice work, Nolan. You've really done a great job," he said, handing him an envelope.

Nolan waited until he was outside to open it, and when he saw his very first paycheck, he whooped with excitement. He thought of the late nights, the difficult customers, and the smell of grease in his work clothes. In that moment, he felt like all those hours on his feet had paid off. Already, he was doing the math, counting how many more paychecks it might take to buy a car.

Which **two** themes are found in the story?

- ☒ Taking responsibilities seriously can open up new opportunities.
- ☒ Teaching yourself to do something is more rewarding than learning from others.
- ☒ Hard work feels worthwhile when it moves people closer to their goals.
- ☒ If you want to stand out from the crowd, you have to take big risks.

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Time elapsed

00

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10

HR MIN SEC

SmartScore

out of 100

0



 Learn with an example or  Watch a video

Read the text.

As an actor, it is your job to deliver lines in a realistic way. However, you must first memorize them.

To begin, handwrite your lines, copying them exactly and focusing on every word. Then, record yourself reading them out loud and play them back repeatedly. You can listen while doing other activities. Next, cover the lines with a scrap of paper, say them, and check them.

Finally, ask someone to "run" your lines with you. Have the person hold the script and read the other roles as you recite your lines. Move around, experiment with your delivery, and allow yourself to make mistakes. Now, you are ready to perform!

Which author's purpose is suggested by the text?

to convince readers to try acting in a play

to teach readers how to learn lines for a play

Submit

Work it out

Not feeling ready yet? These can help:



Identify the author's purpose and message



Identify the purpose of a text (78)

Questions answered

0

Time elapsed

00 00 12
HR MIN SEC

SmartScore
out of 100 ?

0



 Learn with an example or  Watch a video

Which sentence is more formal?

A tropical cyclone is a strong circular storm that begins over warm oceans near the equator.

A tropical cyclone is a real big storm that begins over warm oceans near the equator.

Submit

Work it out

Not feeling ready yet? This can help:

Questions answered

0

Time elapsed

00 00 18
HR MIN SEC

SmartScore
out of 100 ?

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 Learn with an example or  Watch a video

Select the passage that has a more **hopeless** tone.

For two years she had worked earnestly and faithfully, making many mistakes and learning from them. She had been rewarded. She had taught her students something, but she felt that they had taught her much more—lessons of tenderness, self-control, and innocent wisdom.

This was what would happen: when she was older, she would be expected to labor in the schoolroom as she labored now in various parts of the house. That was all there seemed to be to look forward to.

Adapted from Lucy Maud Montgomery, Anne of Avonlea and Frances Hodgson Burnett, A Little Princess

Submit

Work it out

Not feeling ready yet? These can help:



Positive and negative connotation



Describe the difference between related words

Questions
answered

0

Time
elapsed

00 00 07
HR MIN SEC

SmartScore
out of 100

0

